means it gave rise to new freshwater species ^ speciation. Evolution is the mechanism by which speciation occurs ^ evolution. Speciation here also involves adaptation and adaptive speciation as the species adopted to freshwater ecosystem.

63.

- Morphological - when trees grew higher, the giraffe's neck got longer;
- Physiological - in the absence of an external source of water, the kangaroo rat in North American deserts can meet all its water requirements through its internal fat oxidation (in which water is a byproduct). It also has the ability to concentrate its urine so that minimal volume of water is used to remove excretory products;
- Behavioural - animals migrating temporarily to a less stressful habitat.

64. Ecotone may be narrow (between grassland and forest) or wide (between forest and desert). It has conditions intermediate to the adjacent ecosystems. Hence, it is a zone of tension. Usually, the number and the population density of the species of an outgoing community decreases as we move away from the community or ecosystem. A well-developed ecotone contains some organisms which are entirely different from that of the adjoining communities.

65. Succession would occur faster in area existing in the middle of the large continent. This is because here seeds of plants belonging to the different seres would reach much faster. Thus, interior part of Wakanda island is more likely to reach ecological climax first.

66. • Edge effect refers to the changes in population or community structures that occur at the boundary of two habitats (ecotone). Sometimes the number of species and the population density of some of the species in the ecotone is much greater than either community. This is called edge effect.

- Niche refers to the unique functional role and position of a species in its habitat or ecosystem. The functional characteristics of a species in its habitat is referred to as 'niche' in that common habitat.